

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1095

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to honor the Appalachian Fair on the occasion of its 100th anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause in their deliberations to recognize those longstanding institutions that have significantly contributed to the cultural, agricultural, and civic life of this State; and

WHEREAS, the Appalachian Fair, a cherished tradition in the Appalachian Highlands, is celebrating its 100th anniversary in 2026, marking a century of service to the people of Northeast Tennessee and the surrounding region; and

WHEREAS, originally established in 1926 in the Gray community of Washington County, the fair was founded to promote agriculture, education, and rural life, providing a venue where local farmers, families, and community leaders could gather to showcase livestock, crops, crafts, and talents; and

WHEREAS, in 1937, the Appalachian Fair Association was formally incorporated as a Tennessee agricultural nonprofit corporation, and over the decades, the fair has grown from a modest local gathering into a premier regional event; and

WHEREAS, in 1976, the General Assembly recognized the fair's significance by elevating it to regional status, affirming its importance to the agricultural and cultural fabric of this State; and

WHEREAS, throughout its history, the Appalachian Fair has remained steadfast in its mission to promote agriculture and agricultural education, encourage youth involvement and leadership development, and celebrate the traditions and heritage of the Appalachian Highlands; and

WHEREAS, generations of young people have participated in the fair through programs such as 4-H, FFA, FCCLA, and other educational initiatives, gaining valuable skills and an appreciation for the importance of agriculture; and

WHEREAS, the Appalachian Fair has demonstrated remarkable resilience, enduring periods of economic hardship, wartime interruption, and public health challenges yet continuing to grow and thrive as a unifying force within the community; and

WHEREAS, today, the fair attracts hundreds of thousands of visitors annually and serves as a gathering place for families and communities, offering agricultural exhibitions, competitions, educational demonstrations, and wholesome entertainment; and

WHEREAS, as it celebrates its centennial under the theme "A Century of Family, Farming, and Fun," the Appalachian Fair stands as a testament to the enduring strength of community, tradition, and shared purpose in Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the Appalachian Fair on the occasion of its 100th anniversary and extend to its organizers, participants, and supporters our best wishes for continued success in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.